Juan Segura

PhD Candidate in Economics, CEMFI

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Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Firm Dynamics, Economic Growth.

Education

- PhD in Economics, **CEMFI** 2027 (expected)
  Advisor: Josep Pijoan-Mas
  - Visiting PhD Student at **New York University**, Spring 2026
- MSc in Economics, **UCL** 2021
- MSc in Health Economics and Decision Science, **UCL** 2019
- BEng in Biomedical Engineering, **UC3M** 2018

References

- Josep Pijoan-Mas
  Professor of Economics
  CEMFI
  pijoan@cemfi.es
- Pau Roldan-Blanco
  Associate Professor
  Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona
  pau.roldan@bse.eu
- Federico Kochen
  Associate Professor
  CEMFI
  federico.kochen@cemfi.es

Research

Job Market Paper

- "Production Beyond the Firm: The Aggregate Value of Subcontracting"

  This paper studies the macroeconomic effects of subcontracting, the practice of delegating parts of production to external firms. Using administrative data on Portuguese firms, I show that a large share of aggregate input spending goes to subcontracting. Larger firms are more likely to subcontract, and those that subcontract do so more intensively. Subcontracting is unique among inputs in how much it moves with output: its expenses have an elasticity of 1.4 with respect to firm-level sales. I build a model of firm dynamics with labor adjustment frictions and task delegation. Firms subcontract for two reasons: flexibility, because delegating production allows them to circumvent adjustment frictions, and specialization, because the subcontractor is more efficient at performing certain tasks. Subcontracting raises aggregate productivity by 3.9%. Flexibility accounts for a fifth of this gain, by letting firms' size track their productivity more closely, and specialization for the remainder. Ignoring subcontracting overstates the productivity losses from firing costs by a sixth, and their output losses by two fifths. Moreover, subcontracting allows firms to absorb idiosyncratic shocks, but its flexibility largely vanishes under aggregate ones.

Working Papers

- "Financing the Scale-Up: Equity, Innovation and Economic Growth"
  with Andrea Guccione.

  Innovative firms rely on external finance to fund their operations, yet debt and equity may play distinct roles in shaping this process. Using balance-sheet and patent-level data on European patenting firms, we document two facts. First, external equity flows to small, young, collateral-poor, faster-growing firms, while debt reaches larger, more collateral-rich firms. Second, real outcomes, including innovation, respond positively to capital inflows, and these responses are substantially larger for external equity. We interpret these facts through a Schumpeterian model of innovation-led growth with financial frictions in which heterogeneous firms finance their operations with retained earnings, debt, and external equity. In the model, financially constrained firms invest less in R&D, because successful innovations are worth less when capital cannot be scaled to exploit them. This gives rise to selection: equity reaches the firms where new capital has the highest return and its effect on innovation is largest. Financial frictions also depress firm entry, further reducing growth. The calibrated model matches the dynamic correlation of patenting to capital injections and its heterogeneity across financing sources. We use the model to quantify the aggregate effects of financial frictions and evaluate growth policies. In the perfect credit benchmark, growth is 1.25 percentage points higher than in the baseline; frictionless equity markets recover 13% of this gap. Government subsidies to external equity deliver the largest welfare gains at low levels of government spending, while R&D subsidies become more effective as spending rises.

- "The Role of Market Power in Capital Taxation"

  Taxing wealth and taxing capital income are not equivalent when returns to investment are heterogeneous. Which tax is preferable depends on the source of this heterogeneity. I compare the two taxes in a model where entrepreneurs face collateral constraints and charge heterogeneous markups. I calibrate the model to the US under different levels of market power within the range of reported values. Replacing the capital income tax with a revenue-neutral wealth tax raises welfare when markups are low, but lowers it when they are high. Together with financial frictions, market power matters through two channels. First, entrepreneurs who grow out of their collateral constraints charge higher markups, which limits the efficiency gains from taxing wealth. Second, profits are part of the capital income tax base but not of the wealth tax base. Profits rise with markups, and so does the wealth tax rate that keeps government revenue constant, thus lowering most households' return to saving and capital accumulation. The second channel is more sensitive to aggregate market power and explains most of the differences across economies. Once transitions are accounted for, taxing wealth still raises welfare only when markups are lowest, but only slightly.

Work in Progress

- "Leading or Following? Technology Adoption, Talent, and the Transatlantic Gap"
  with Nicolò Ceneri.

Pre-PhD Work

- "Addressing Missing Data in the Estimation of Time-varying Treatments in Comparative Effectiveness Research"
  with Manuel Gomes and Clemence Leyrat.
  Statistics in Medicine, 2023.
- "IMU-based Study on Gait and Balance in Parkinson's Disease and Healthy Subjects"
  with Javier Ricardo Perez-Sanchez et al.
  Movement Disorders, 2020.

Presentations in Conferences and Seminars (*Scheduled)

2026 NYU Macro Lunch PhD, XXIX Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics, UCL Macroeconomics Workshop, CEMFI Macro Workshop, European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (EWMES)*

2025 Madrid Macro Mountain (poster session), CEMFI Macro Workshop

2024 Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía (SAEe), CEMFI Macro Workshop

2021 European Causal Inference Meeting (virtual), Health Economists' Study Group Winter Meeting (virtual)

Teaching Experience (TA)

- Microeconomics, **CEMFI** — Fall 2025
- International Macroeconomics, **CEMFI** — Winter 2025
- Microeconometrics, **CEMFI** — Fall 2023
- Modelling for Decision Science, **UCL** — Winter 2020
- Econometrics for Health, **UCL** — Fall 2019

Academic Service

- Referee: *SERIEs – Journal of the Spanish Economic Association*
- Coordinator of the Macroeconomics PhD Workshop at **CEMFI** — 2024 – 2025

Other Experience

- Research Assistant, **UCL Department of Economics** — 2021 – 2022
- Research Assistant, **Institute for the Future of Work** — 2019 – 2020
- Research Assistant, **UCL Centre for Global Health Economics** — 2019 – 2020
- Research Assistant, **Cajal Institute**, Spanish National Research Council — 2017 – 2018

Scholarships and Awards

- FPI Predoctoral Fellowship, Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation — 2023 – Present
- CEMFI Scholarship — 2021 – 2023
- Dean's List, Faculty of Social and Historical Sciences, UCL — 2021
- Fundación Mutua Madrileña Postgraduate Scholarship — 2020 – 2021
- Ramón Areces Foundation Scholarship — 2018 – 2019
- Excellence Grant, Community of Madrid — 2018
- Scholarship to Visiting Students, UC3M — 2016
- Excellence Grant, Community of Madrid — 2015

Additional Information

- Citizenship: Spanish.
- Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent).
- Software: Matlab, Julia, Stata, R, LaTeX.

Last updated: October 27, 2026